

The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

Scorge30@hotmail.com

This Forgotten Realms adventure is designed for a party of four to six characters of ninth to twelfth levels (about 50 total levels). Due to the amount of magic and traps present within the adventure, the party should include at least one mage and thief. Several of the rooms are near geothermal regions creating temperatures near the maximum of human endurance. Lacking sufficient magic to protect themselves from such extremes of temperature, the characters could suffer damage from dehydration and exposure to extreme high temperatures followed by ambient underground temperatures. The DM may desire to use alternate rules for tracking the characters exposure to high and low temperatures and dehydration as there are no sources of water within the complex. Although there are several Drow NPCs within the adventure, the party does not have to include a Drow character, but a party comprised of character races or types tolerant of Drow works best. The book I, Tyrant would be useful for obtaining an exact understanding of the gauth, but is not necessary for play. The book Drow of the Underdark details the drow deities and explains renegade drow, and material for this adventure was drawn largely from this volume so a copy should be available for the DM but the adventure can be ran without it. Several creatures are taken from the Greyhawk Adventures and Forgotten Realms Monstrous Compendium Appendixes, although this adventure is not set within Oerth. The DM lacking these volumes might substitute creatures suitable to his campaign. The magical candles taken from Dragon Magazine #147 "Magic for Beginners" by Gregory W. Detwiler and Dragon Magazine #179 "Unique Magical Candles for Your Campaign" by Gregg Chamberlain can be substituted for other magical items suitable to the DM's campaign. The dread portals taken from Dragon Magazine #102 "Open Them if You Dare" by Ed Greenwood may be substituted for other portals suitable to the DM's campaign. The god Goibhnie¹ is from the Celtic mythos found in the original hardback book Deities and Demigods², his worshippers are predominately blacksmiths that fervently seek out all forms of weapons. Temples and shrines dedicated to Goibhnie are often filled with weapons left as offerings, and a devout worshipper or one desiring the deity's favor may even leave a magical weapon.

The city of Bartlesville³ purposely left vague allowing the DM to drop this adventure into an existing Forgotten Realms campaign, and is intended to be somewhere in the North. The city's predominately human population is about 1,500. Its major industries are smithing, fur trading, wagon and barrel making, and leather production. This city boasts the largest temple in the Realms dedicated to the god Goibhnie, the blacksmith of the gods. Flanking this temple are two temples dedicated to the other two deities that comprise the triad craftsman-gods, Luchta and Creidhne.

For the Players:

Read or paraphrase the following to the players:

While traveling through the small trading city of Bartlesville, you hear a town crier announcing that the temple of Goibhnie is seeking to hire adventurers to complete the search of a nearby ruined tower. While listening to the crier's sales pitch, it seems as if this tower was recently discovered, partially searched and a large amount of gold was sighted but unrecovered. However, a magical sword was recovered and now rests in the temple of Goibhnie's treasury. Interested adventuring bands are directed to see Gharri of Goibhnie, the high priest of Goibhnie in Bartlesville.

The town crier making the announcements is doing exactly what he has been paid to do. He has no further information and does not make any more money if someone volunteers to perform this adventure. Pumping him for information without coin reveals nothing, but a few silver pieces reveals that a small mounted patrol of about seven fighters from the city were attacked by a large group of orcs. Fleeing from the orcs, with several members wounded, they accidentally discovered this ruined tower. Only three members of the patrol returned to the city, bearing a magical, glowing sword taken from the tower. The survivors were healed in the temple of Goibhnie, and told some wild rumors about a "floating, many-eyed, round glowing beast with a gaping mouth full of fangs that slew several of the fighters and chased the survivors from the tower." Somehow, they managed to elude the orcs and made it back to the city.

For the DM:

When the patrol fled from the orcs into the tower, they discovered the gauth, the unwitting door guard for a small band of renegade drow. The third floor of the ruined tower contains a magical teleporting mirror to a fixed location in the Underdark. The mirror is hidden within an extra dimensional space and the drow know the command word to recall it. The renegade drow are using the area near the destination the mirror teleports to, and know of the gauth, although the gauth does not know of the drow, nor is it aware of the mirror. Madame Nova, a female fighter/mage/cleric of Vhaeraun⁴ leads the drow, and although Vhaeraun is predominately worshipped by males, Madame Nova has displayed excellent service to the deity and he has seen fit to grant the woman spells in his service. These drow although of evil alignments if approached peacefully and respectfully, will gladly trade information with the characters and even some minor articles as decided by the DM. The orcs knew that a terrible creature lived within the tower and were not foolish enough to risk their lives, and figured that the creature would destroy the patrol and left. Unless the DM desires, the orcs are not part of this adventure.

The DM should make this adventure seem like a straight "bug hunt and kill" adventure and should not dissuade the players from making assumptions about the gauth. Most likely they will assume it is a beholder, and may make preparations for encountering a beholder which may not help them much against a gauth. Gauth are particularly

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dangerous to mages, and some of the experts believe that these beholder-kin were bred to deal with mages threatening a hive. The particular gauth in this tower is a solitary beholder-kin, but is otherwise a normal example of his species. The tower was once the home of a reclusive mage and when the gauth moved in, there were enough magical items to keep it fed. Lately the magical items have been running low, and the gauth is hunting the nearby forest and road for items to eat. The renegade drow occasionally “drop” a magical item for the gauth to eat hoping to retain their door guard. The drow only occasionally use this entrance because of the danger of the gauth and keep it for emergencies.

The Temple of Goibhnie

The temple lay out and description should be modified to fit the DM’s campaign. Some suggestions for decorations are groves of apple, oak and yew trees (far from the buildings, the vapors can stun people), flocks of guardian geese and magic item retrieving ducks⁵, casks or offerings of various food stuffs and perhaps a few snakes (a symbol of fertility to the ancient Celts⁶). The clergy of Goibhnie specialize in the crafting of exceptionally fine weapons. Those weapons that are not magical receive a +1 to both damage and to strike due to their exceptional balance⁷. For church members of high status and for the slaying of dreadful enemies, the clergy of Goibhnie specialize in the crafting of soul eating weapons, and weapons of wounding. These are almost exclusively for use by church members and almost unheard of outside of the church.

The high priest of Goibhnie is a short balding human male with a large gut and huge arms with rippling muscles and prominent veins. His hands and face bear the tell tale marks of a blacksmith, and his harsh voice is used to screaming over a forge. He is dressed in soot-stained, rough cotton tunic with a thick leather apron, leather trousers, and large leather boots. A thick, braided iron and gold torque⁸ encircles his neck. The ends of the torque each have a pair of Janus heads inset with small precious gems where the eyes should be. He introduces himself as Lord High Smith Gharri (Jar-ee) of Goibhnie and motions for the adventurers to take a seat. After taking, a seat behind a scarred and stained plain oak desk he gets immediately to business. If the characters are interested he pulls a simple map from the desk and points to the general location of the tower and explains the temple’s need for the adventurer’s services:

An attack upon one of the city’s mounted patrols by a superior force of orcs happened in the mountains north of the city. Badly wounded, outnumbered, and running for their lives, the orcs chased the patrol for two days. By accident, they came upon a large stone ruined tower set in the center of a small grove of fir trees. Seeking shelter inside, to their amazement, the orcs did not follow them into the tower and soon left never to be seen again.

While searching the tower, the patrol uncovered a small amount of gold coins and a magical, glowing sword on the third floor. Near the sword was a large oak chest that resisted all their efforts to open, and it was their opinion that it is probably magically sealed. They also noted an odd, 10’ diameter vertical hole that went through all three levels of the tower. While standing on the third floor a terrible round beast with several eyes floated up from the basement and attacked, slaying several members immediately. The survivors fled from the tower taking the sword with them. They returned to the city and entered the temple where we healed them and they donated the sword to our treasury, since our faith collects unique weapons.

I would like you to return to the temple, slay this beast if possible, and retrieve any more magical weapons that may be there. Any coin or other magical items retrieved from the ruins are yours to keep, but the temple receives any unique or magical weapons.

Gharri gives the adventurers a simple map to the tower, a rough schematic of the layout of the tower, and explains that the trip to the tower will take about three days. If the adventurers are reluctant to take the adventure, he offers each character 500 gp for completing the task payable upon return with proof of the death of the creature. If they are unable to slay the creature, then a decent description and location earns each character 250 gp. Depending upon the amount of magical items the characters are carrying, Gharri might offer some minor healing magic items like potions, scrolls, or two *Acorns of Healing* (treat as a *Potion of Extra Healing*) per character that accepts this adventure.

High Smith Gharri of Goibhnie: AL LG; AC 6; MV 11; P16; THACO 10; #AT 3/2; Dmg by weapon; S 19 (18/38 without the torque), D 16, C 15, I 16, W 17, Ch 11; ML 15; *Torque of Hill Giant Strength*. Gharri is a cloistered cleric and does not actively keep spells memorized unless traveling. When traveling he wears *Plate Mail* +4 and wields a *Warhammer* +3; spells as befitting the DM’s campaign.

Characters that desire to receive the blessing of Goibhnie may leave an offering of a weapon or coins in the temple. Leaving an offering in all three of the god’s temples incurs the greatest chance of receiving a blessing upon the adventure. The nature of this blessing determined by the DM accord to his campaign, should not make the adventure easier or absolve the players of skillful role-play and problem solving. The characters may remain within the temple for up to three days free of charge preparing for the adventure. Staying longer in the city reveals nothing further about the ruins.

Travel to the Ruined Tower

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The tower is about three days travel from the city through very mild, temperate terrain. The weather is pleasant, warm and dry without being too hot and the travel is through low rolling hills covered with dense pine and hardwood forests. The DM should roll once per day for random encounters.

Temperate Forest Random Encounters

1	Wyvern (4): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL NE; AC 3; MV 6, Fl 24(E); HD 7+7; hp 33, 2x35, 41; THAC0 13; #AT 2; Dmg 2-16/1-6 (poison stinger); SA Poison (save vs. poison or die, if save take 1d6 dmg); SZ G; ML Elite (14); XP 1,400.
2	Wolfwere: Int. High to Exceptional (13-16); AL CE; AC 3; MV 15; HD 5+1; hp 20; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg 2-12 and by weapon; SA Singing brings on lethargy; SD Iron or +1 or better weapon to hit; SZ M; ML Elite (14); XP 1,400.
3	Bear, Brown: Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 6; MV 12; HD 5+5; hp 23; THAC0 15; #AT 3; Dmg 1-6/1-6/1-8; SA Hug (2d6); SZ L; ML Average (8-10); XP 420.
4	Dog, Wild (5): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 7; MV 15; HD 1+1; hp 2x8, 7, 4, 2; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-4; SZ S; ML Unsteady (5-7); XP 35.
5	Leucrotta, Greater (2): Int. 11-12 Very intelligent; AL NE; AC 4; MV 18; HD 8; hp 30, 35; THAC0 13; #AT 1; see below; Dmg 3d6; see below; SA See Below; SD See Below; SZ L; ML Champion (15-16); XP 2,000.
6	Hobgoblin (8): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 5; MV 9; HD 1+1; hp 7, 3x9, 2x6, 2x3; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35.
7	Griffon (2): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 3; MV 12, Fl 30(C); HD 7; hp 32, 34; THAC0 13; #AT 3; Dmg 1-4/1-4/2-16; SZ L; ML Steady (11-12); XP 650.
8	Skulk: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL CE; AC 7; MV 12; HD 2; hp 5; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SA Backstab; SD See below; SZ M; ML Unsteady (5-7); XP 120.
9	Troll, Giant: Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 4; MV 12; HD 8; hp 39; THAC0 13; #AT 1; Dmg club (2d6+7); SD Regeneration (2hp/rnd except fire dmg), takes at least 10 pts fire dmg to kill; SZ L; ML Fanatic (17-18); XP 1,400.
10	Hippogriff (2): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 5; MV 18, Fl 36(C); HD 3+3; hp 12, 16; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-6/1-6/1-10; SZ L; ML Average (9); XP 175.

The Ruined Tower

As you approach the tower, you can see that Gharri spoke correctly when he described the conditions of the tower. The tower itself is a squat square construction made of smooth mortared blocks of native stone. Several parts of the tower have fallen to the ground, and all of the other buildings around the tower's perimeter are destroyed. The four majestic fir trees that surround the tower almost hide it from sight, and it would be easy to miss in the dark without the map. You notice an odd thing; a relatively new crude thatched roof covers the stables, while the rest of the tower seems ancient.

Attached to the tower on the southern side is a large square stable that has a decent roof. In the southern end of the stable shut tightly, are two large iron-reinforced wooden doors. These doors are not locked but are barred from the inside. On the north wall, lying on the ground outside, is a pair of identical doors. There is no light within the tower, although the interior is dimly lit by sunlight filtering in through the arrow slits.

The DM should have the characters make a notice roll, giving rangers and elves a slight bonus, to see if they notice the complete lack of animal noise in the surrounding forest. Searching the perimeter of the tower reveals that about 25 mounted horses entered the area. Only seven horses approached the tower on the northern side. These seven horses were picketed within the trees and did not enter the tower, while their riders did. The other horses milled around the area outside the grove and although some of their riders dismounted (revealing orcish riders⁹), they did not enter the tower or the grove and left soon after.

All dimensions of the tower are 25' square, with a 10' high ceiling unless otherwise noted.

T1. Tower First Floor.

The inside of the tower is dimly lit from the outside by sunlight filtering in through the arrow slits. Within the center of the wooden floor is a jagged 10' diameter hole. The wooden ceiling of this room, which is the floor of the room above, has an identical hole. Looking up through the hole reveals that the third floor also has a hole in the floor. The perimeter of the hole is sturdy and the floor will support several characters at once, but not the horses. The hole appears to have been cut with either magic or a large tool, but was not done by force.

A rickety flight of wooden stairs climbing the eastern wall allows access to the upper floors. A small fireplace on the western wall is full of cold ashes and small bits of charred wood. A broken stone-top table lies in the south

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eastern corner of the room near the stairs. Set in the center of the southern wall is a pair of rusty iron-reinforced wooden doors, shut tightly. The wooden floor bears the jumbled and smeared tracks of several humans wearing boots. A few of these tracks enter the stable.

The stone-top table was once a fine piece of marble six feet long with oak legs and brass bracing. The ruined table has nothing of worth, except a few pieces of moldy parchment, water damaged but usable. The double doors are not locked and will open on rusty protesting hinges revealing the stables.

The 10' diameter hole in the center of the tower descends 30' to end in room #T5, the foyer to the gauth's lair. A character dropping through this hole is likely to encounter the gauth, although the gauth would rather wait until the intruders are within the stables where it has prepared its trap, it will attack anything that enters its lair.

While the characters are searching the first floor, unless they are being careful and quiet, there is a 90% chance that the gauth will be alerted to their presence and will silently observe the characters waiting to attack, trying to discern which ones might be spell casters. It will cast *Invisibility* upon itself and watch silently as the characters search the tower. Those characters displaying the use of spells are noted and will be attacked first, preferably in the stables. When the characters head for the stables, it will float through the underground chasm, rising under the false hay pile using several eyes to watch the progress of the characters. If discovered, the gauth immediately attacks.

T2, The Stable.

This dry stable is dark, 25' wide by 50' long and appears empty. The crude thatched roof seems to be holding the majority of the weather out. Within the stable are 10 wooden stalls along the western wall and a 10' high pile of dry straw on the eastern wall. To the south hang a pair of rusty iron-reinforced wooden doors that are barred by an equally rusty iron-reinforced wooden crosspiece set into rusty iron rings on the doors and walls.

Searching the stalls reveals that four of the stalls each contain a different stone statue. Stall number one has a large owlbear statue standing on its hind legs with its head raised as if to look at something. Stall number two has a large white tail buck frozen while jumping. Stall number three has a male human warrior dressed in scale mail with a bastard sword raised over his head in a two-handed strike and a frozen look of utter terror on his face. Stall number four has a human female dressed in course robes half reclining on a pile of blankets on the floor with her hands covering her eyes while her mouth is open in a silent scream.

The gauth will wait until the characters are all looking at the statues, which puts their backs to him. He will then rise slowly from the hay, cause himself to glow brightly and commences to blast the characters with his eyes, trying to keep as many characters within the effective range of his central eye as possible.

Gauth 9+9 HD: Int. 15-16 Exceptionally intelligent; AL NE; AC 0; MV 0, Fl 9(B); HD 9+9; hp 51; THAC0 11; #AT 1; Dmg 3-12; SA Magic; SD Regeneration; SZ L; ML Champion-Fanatic (15-18); XP 9,000¹⁰.

The Gauth is a relative of the beholder that feeds on magic. Located in the center of the gauth's forward hemisphere is a large central eye surrounded by a ring of smaller eyes that are protected by ridges of tough flesh. These secondary body eyes provide the creature with normal vision in lighted areas and infravision to 90 feet. On the underside is the beast's fearsome mouth with its accompanying cluster of four feeding tendrils, while the top is adorned with a crown of six eyestalks. Attacks on the creature hit as follows:

Roll	Location	AC	Hit Points
01-85	Body	0	As listed
86-90	Central Eye	7	Part of Body
91-00	Eyestalk/Tendrils	2	6 hit points

When a gauth moves into combat, it begins to glow, much as if it were the object of a faerie fire spell, to attract the attention of its foes. A creature that meets the gaze of the central eye must roll a successful saving throws vs. spell, with a -2 penalty, or be affected as if the victim of a feeblemind spell. If a gauth chooses to bite with its great maw, the sharp fangs inflict 3d4 points of damage. The four tendrils around the mouth can grab and hold victims as if they had Strength of 18, but they can inflict no damage.

A gauth in combat can also employ its six eyestalks. These eyes have the following powers: 1. Cause serious wounds (as spell, 30-foot range). 2. Repulsion (as spell, 10-foot wide path, 40-foot range) 3. Cone of cold (as spell, inflicts 3d4 points of damage and has an area of effect 5 feet wide at the start, 50 feet long, and 20 feet wide at the base; this eye can be used only three times per day) 4. Lightning bolt (as spell, inflicts 4d4 damage with 80' range; this power can be used up to four times per day) 5. Paralyzation (as wand, 40-foot range, single target; only a dispel magic or the beholder's death can free the victim) 6. Dweomer drain (see below)

Dweomer drain permits the gauth to drain charges from magical items. It has a 40-foot range and can be targeted on one individual per round. In addition to preventing one object from functioning for the duration of that round, this power drains one charge from one charged object. Permanent objects, such as magical swords, are rendered powerless for one round by this ability. The dweomer drain does not affect artifacts. The eye has no effect on spells that

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have been memorized (but not yet cast) and it will not break the concentration of a wizard. It does neutralize any spell cast by its target that round, however.

A dispel magic spell cast on any of the gauth's eyestalks prevents its use for 1d4 rounds. The central eye, any fully retracted eyestalks, the body's ability to glow, and the gauth's natural levitation are not subject to injury by such a spell.

If a gauth is slain, its magical energy dissipates. Usually, this is a harmless event, but there is a 2% chance that it is catastrophic, inflicting 4d4 points of damage to all creatures within 10 feet (no saving throw). Gauth are immune to their own powers and to those of other gauth. They have an unusual physiology that enables them to regenerate 1 hit point every two turns.

Saving Throws:

Creature hit points	Saves as
45-49	10th level warrior
50-59	12th level warrior
60-69	14th level warrior
70+	16th level warrior

If the battle goes against the gauth, it will plummet through the hole under the hay pile and retreat into its lair room number #T6.

The statues are normal stone statues carved of fine granite by a master craftsman with morbid tastes. To an interested collector each statue might fetch 5-10 gp, but the weight of each statue and the trouble of transporting them are not worth the effort.

T3, The Tower Second Level.

This room is almost identical in size and layout as the one below it, however in this room the stairs run up the southern wall. A large, moldy and badly stained rug lies in a crumpled heap under the stairs. A fireplace fills the center of the western wall with a ruined chase lounge in front of it. Beside the fireplace on the left is a small wooden nightstand with the twin doors ripped off the face lying upon its side against the wall. Lying on its side in the southwestern corner of the room is a small wooden table with three legs. A few pine needles rest on the table's edge. The wooden roof is badly warped and water-damaged, and has a fierce case of mold and rot. The floor in this room shows signs of water damage and the beginning of rot and mildew. Occasionally a small drop of water falls through the roof.

Closer inspection reveals that the tabletop is badly gouged, punctured in several places, and might have served as a target for some bodies practice. Searching the nightstand reveals that it is empty and worthless. Under the nightstand is a small secret trap door that is locked but not trapped. Inside the small wooden recess in the floor is: a unique small *Bag Of Holding 175 Pounds* that contains 40 gp (ancient Waterdeep mint), 30 brilliant rubies (exquisite fakes that appear to be worth 40 gp each), and two delicate pink crystal vials of *Extra-Healing Potions* (each poisoned with a single *Invisible* throat leech).

Leech, Throat (2): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 10; MV 1, Sw 1; HD 0+1; hp 2x1; THAC0 20; #AT 1; Dmg 1-3; SA choke; SZ T; ML Unsteady (6); XP 35.

T4, The Tower Third Level.

Entering this room, you would assume that it would be very similar to the two previous rooms; with the exception, that most of this room and the rest of the tower has fallen to the ground below. A short flight of stairs ending in space runs briefly along the western wall. Small puddles of water dot this room and the floor makes ominous noises when stepped on. A gaping hole in the western wall is all that remains of the fireplace, and small birds have roosted in some of the remaining stones. A large portion of the north and eastern walls survive. Lying on its side in the northeast corner is a large iron bound chest that is badly scratched and dented but seems sound. A lock made of iron is inset into the chest, and this area has suffered the most abuse, but it seems to no avail.

The chest has a 10th-level *Wizard Lock* spell upon it as well as a rusty padlock effectively welding the chest shut. Opening the chest requires a total of 75 points of damage be dealt to it, or a strong acid or other means allowing access. The DM should reward creative players that gain access to the chest without damaging the contents. Opening the chest reveals 15 gp, 15 sp (ancient Silvermoon mint), three gold trade bars each worth 150 gp and three scrolls in a cracked leather case. The scrolls bear the spells *Knock*, *Wizard Eye*, and *Fireball*. Under the scrolls is a pair of matched throwing daggers and nine vial bombs¹¹ whose command phrase is "From mine, unto thine, may you suffer the ills of my gift" which must be spoken the night before use, which magically fills the activated vial with *Firewater*¹² creating a magical grenade.

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Searching the chest for secret compartments reveals a false bottom. Searching the false bottom for traps reveals a complex poisoned needle trap, of such design that the thief attempting to disarm the trap suffers a –25% chance of success. Failure to disarm the trap triggers the poison needle, which is coated with class D poison¹³. Opening the secret compartment reveals a small silvery cloth bag, and an ivory scroll case sealed with red wax. Inside the bag are four large magical candles. Three of these candles are *Candles Of Defense*¹⁴ and one is a *Candle Of Flame*, which may be mistaken for one of the other three candles.

The scroll case is protected by a 12th-level *Sepia Snake Sigil* spell. Opening the scroll case reveals a single piece of parchment with a short riddle upon it:

“I am the twin faced-god of beginning,

My name starts the new year.

All doors and gates fall under my protection.

Open my door in time of war,

Close my door in time of peace.

Speak my name so that what was hid shall be revealed.”

The answer is Janus¹⁵ and speaking the deity’s name aloud causes a small magical vortex to open depositing a large mirror in the northeast corner of the room.

Suddenly a magical vortex erupts within the room and deposits a large, body-sized mirror mounted to the walls in the northeast corner. A thick, gilded iron frame holds the mirror, which seems to be made of a single pane of glass.

The mirror and its frame are quite shiny and appear as if freshly made. Apparently stored within some extra-dimensional space, the magic within the area prevented that portion of the tower from collapsing. Casting a *Detect Magic* spell upon the mirror reveals that it is quite magical. Tossing anything into the mirror causes it to disappear instantly. The mirror is a one-way *Mirror of Teleportation* that sends one man-sized and smaller object entering the mirror to a fixed location with the Underdark per round. The location is room number one in the Under Halls. The mirror will remain on this dimension for one turn, after which it disappears again until called forth by the command word. The mirror is a relic, is indestructible, and is not able to be removed.

If the characters have not encountered the gauth, and they have discovered the mirror’s properties (which the gauth may have observed), it will immediately attack. Another option is holding the gauth’s attack back until part of the party has passed through the mirror and attacking those remaining. Of course, the gauth will follow the characters into the mirror and the renegade drow will not be thrilled at the appearance of a gauth following the characters.

T5, The Basement of the Tower.

The vertical hole through the floor appears to be the only means of accessing the basement. If there was another way, it has probably been destroyed.

The 10’-diameter vertical shaft descends 30’ through the rock and earth to end in an expertly hallowed-out basement under the tower. A smooth stone landing that is 15’ wide and 20’ long lies at the center of the shaft within a room that is 25’ wide and 30’ long. At the northern end of the room, a large stone arch permits access into the next room. A pair of ruined iron-reinforced doors lie just outside the room, the remains of the hinges are still hanging upon the stone walls. The walls are very smooth and the rooms still air is musty with a thick poignant aroma, like rotting vegetation. Surrounding the landing on all sides is a thick patch of fungi that completely covers the floor and ends at the stone arch. Several of the fungi are nearly five feet tall.

The gauth has carefully tended and cultivated this patch of fungi, even carrying water to it from the forest within its mouth. The gauth dumps the carcasses from its meals and any other handy matter within the fungi to feed it. There are ten shriekers and five violet fungi; the rest of the fungi are normal, if large specimens.

Fungus, Shrieker (10): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 1; HD 3; hp 2x10, 11, 16, 17, 6, 20, 18, 23, 5; THAC0 17; #AT 0; Dmg Nil; SD Noise; SZ M; ML Steady (12); XP 120.

Fungus, Violet (5): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 1; HD 3; hp 19, 14, 10, 11, 6; THAC0 17; #AT 1-4; Dmg Special; SA Rot flesh in one round unless save vs. poison; SZ M; ML Steady (12); XP 175.

The ruined doors were forced from inside the room with the fungi. There are no obvious tool marks upon the doors to suggest how they might have been forced. Lifting the doors reveals a broken oak crosspiece lying on the stone floor under the doors.

T6, The Living Quarters of the Gauth.

This large, rough-hewn cavern has a roof 15’ high and the room is approximately 48’ wide and 60’ long. The walls are rough with the cracks and crevices left from excavation. The room is dark, musty, and dotted with piles of

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debris. Most of the debris is what you would expect to find in a large storeroom under a keep, barrels of provisions, crates of supplies, and other usual material. Several of these crates and barrels have been ransacked and some of the material is scattered about the room. Towards the back of the room in the southern part, is a large pile of material making what looks like a nest. Along the western wall are piles of hay bales and sacks of molding grain, along with several ruined saddles and other pieces of tack.

The DM should adjust the description of the room to match the events that have happened so far. Should the gauth already be slain, then its lair is running loose within the room, and make sure that you mention the movement. A wounded gauth would retreat here and the final battle could end within this room. In the unlikely event that the gauth is still alive, then its lair will still be frozen which consists of three mule deer, a large black bear, and a winged owlbear. The deer and black bear are too confused to pose a threat to the characters, but the owlbear is quite enraged and will attack.

Winged Owlbear: Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL N; AC 3; MV 12; HD 7+2; hp 44; THAC0 12; #AT 3; Dmg 1-8/1-8/3-12; SA If hit with 18 or better, victim is drawn into hug (2-16/rnd auto hit); SZ L; ML Steady (11-12); XP 420.

Bear, Black: Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 7; MV 12; HD 3+3; hp 19; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-3/1-3/1-6; SA Hug (2d4); SZ M; ML Average (8-10); XP 175.

The deer are AC 7 and each has 8 hp but they are non-combatants. A Ranger character has a slight chance of pacifying the deer, but with the scents of so many predators around, it will be difficult. Speaking to the deer provides no useful information; the deer have no idea of how much time has elapsed.

Searching the room reveals several torch scones along both walls from which 15 usable torches are recovered. Searching the crates reveals several brass hooded lanterns and several gallons of lamp oil. Underneath the false hay pile is the remains of a large dumbwaiter, once used to raise and lower supplies from the storage area. Within the large pile of debris in the center of the room, are two large pieces of art worth 1,198 and 776 gp respectfully to an interested collector. In the wrong market, both objects might fetch one-eighth of their value. Buried in the center of the pile is a large open and unlocked chest of coins. The chest contains 81 pp, 2,099 cp, 41 gp, and four glass vials filled with liquid and a metallic flask with a bronze stopper filled with an orange fluid. The four glass vials are three *Potions of Extra-Healing*, and one *Potion of Superheroism*. The metallic flask contains a *Potion of Rainbow Hues* with enough for seven careful draughts.

The Under Halls

While traveling within the Under Halls, the DM should check twice per day and once per night for random encounters. A DM desiring to expand these halls may wish to create new encounter tables.

Underdark Random Encounters

Roll	Result
1	Troglodyte (11): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 5; MV 12; HD 2; hp 12, 6, 3x14, 3x11, 2x8, 7; THAC0 19; #AT 3; Dmg 1-2/1-2/2-5 or 2-8 weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11); XP 120. Troglodyte, Guard (5): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 5; MV 12; HD 3; hp 15, 12, 11, 18, 7; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-2/1-2/2-5 or 2-8 weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11); XP 175. Troglodyte, Subchieftain (4): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 5; MV 12; HD 4; hp 22, 2x14, 23; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-2/1-2/2-5 or 2-8 weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11); XP 270.
2	Lizard, Subterranean (5): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 5; MV 12; HD 6; hp 22, 29, 31, 17, 32; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg 2-12; SA If hits with a 20, take double dmg (2-24) and 2-12 each rnd (no attack roll); SZ H; ML Average (8-10); XP 650.
3	Spider, Huge (3): Int. 1 Animal intelligence; AL N; AC 6; MV 18; HD 2+2; hp 14, 10, 16; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-6; SA Poison, leap; SZ M; ML Average (8); XP 270.
4	Tren (10): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL CE; AC 4; MV 12, Sw 9; HD 3+3; hp 18, 2x13, 2x14, 9, 10, 12, 23, 11; THAC0 17; #AT 3 or 1; Dmg 1d3/1d3/1d6+1 or by weapon; SA See Below; SD See Below; SZ M; ML Elite (13-14); XP 175.
5	Ghoul, Ghast (4): Int. 11-12 Very intelligent; AL CE; AC 4; MV 15; HD 4; hp 18, 17, 14, 24; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-4/1-4/1-8; SA paralyzation (5-10 rnds), save vs. stench (-2) or retching & nausea; SD immune to sleep & charm, take double dmg from cold iron weapons; SZ M; ML Elite (13-14); XP 650. Ghoul (10): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 2; hp 2x13, 14, 8, 2x10, 2x11, 15, 4; THAC0 19; #AT 3; Dmg 1-3/1-3/1-6; SA Paralyzation (3-8 turns); SD immune to sleep & charm; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 175.

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

6	Mongrelman 4 HD (10): Int. Low to Average (5-10); AL LN; AC 5; MV 9; HD 4; hp 15, 20, 23, 2x14, 2x16, 19, 26, 12; THAC0 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1-10 or by weapon type; SD Camouflage, Mimicry; SZ M; ML Steady (12); XP 175.
7	Carrion Crawler : Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 12; HD 3+1; hp 15; THAC0 17; #AT 1 or 8; Dmg Either bite for 1-2 or 8 tentacle attacks for paralysis.; SA Paralysis; SZ L; ML Fearless (20); XP 420.
8	Giant, Fomorian (4): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL NE; AC 3; MV 9; HD 13+3; hp 63, 62, 64, 66; THAC0 9; #AT 1; Dmg 2d4 + 8 or by weapon (2x normal damage + 8); SA Surprise; SD Only surprised on a 1; SZ H; ML Elite (14); XP 6,000.
9	Xorn : Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL N; AC -2; MV 9, Br 9; HD 7+7; hp 44; THAC0 13; #AT 4; Dmg 1-3/1-3/1-3/6-24; SA Surprise, pass through stone; SD immune to fire & cold, half dmg from edged weapons & electrical attacks; SZ M; ML Champion (16); XP 4,000.
10	Orc, Shaman 6HD: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 6; hp 36; THAC0 11; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon); SA spells as 6th level priest; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 675; Memorized: <i>Light, Cure Light Wounds</i> (x2), <i>Cause Light Wounds</i>, <i>Shillelagh</i>, <i>Hold Person</i>, <i>Cloak of Fear</i>¹⁶. Orc, Subchief: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 4; MV 9; HD 1d1+10; hp 11; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon, +1 damage); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35. Orc, Leader (5): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 4; MV 9; HD 2; hp 16, 10, 12, 8, 4; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon, +1 damage); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35. Orc assistant (15): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 1d1+7; hp 15x8; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 15. Orc with sword and flail (10): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 1; hp 4, 8, 2x1, 3x5, 2, 6, 3; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (sword) or 2-7 (flail); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 15.

Speaking the correct answer to the riddle found near the arch activates the two teleporting arches found within the Under Halls. The answer must be spoken in the same language as the riddle was written in. Other than trial and error, there is no way to discern if an answer was correct. Tossing items such as copper coins or small stones into the arch and seeing if they disappear is probably the safest way to test the validity of an answer. After speaking the correct answer, the arches will transport up to 12 individual items one way, for game purposes consider an adventurer and all carried gear as one item. Each arch is useable once per day and remains activated for a turn before shutting off.

A mage that has carefully studied portals, gates, and similar devices or has consulted with sages about these devices has a chance determined by the DM to possess some knowledge of the workings of portals. The DM according to his campaign determines the results of casting such magics as *Legend Lore* upon the gates.

Room #1, A Hot Arrival.

You arrive in a dark, dry hellishly hot hallway that is 15' wide and 50' long. The walls are made of smoothed stone mined from the rock and rise nine feet to support a smooth roof. Behind you is a blank stonewall; ahead of you (facing south) the hallway terminates in a pair of stone doors shut tightly.

The temperature within this hallway is about 155° Fahrenheit that renders infravision useless. Proceeding south, the temperature lowers slightly.

The native stone twin doors are devoid of any knobs, handles or latches. Both doors are *Wizard Locked* by a 16th level mage. Dispelling the *Wizard Lock* spell allows the doors to open into the next room. No wards are upon the doors preventing other magics. Using such spells as *Dimension Door* and *Teleport* allows the characters to pass through.

Room #2, A Strange Doorman.

On the other side of the double doors, the hallway continues for another 20' ending in another pair of double stone doors identical to the previous doors. However, standing in front of these new doors is an eight-foot tall earth-brown humanoid. Midway through the hall a faint red light emanates from a large glowing symbol upon the floor, dimly lighting the hallway. The temperature is noticeably cooler here than in the previous hallway (about 109° Fahrenheit). The roof starts at nine feet high at the door but rises sharply to about 12' high at the new pair of doors. As you enter the hallway, the large humanoid begins a slow lumbering walk towards you.

Placed here to defend these doors from intruders the tall humanoid is a clay golem commanded to let drow pass only. If the adventuring party includes drow, the golem ignores these adventurers and attacks the other adventurers only. Its command word is "abbil¹⁷" (Drow for comrade or trusted friend) which returns it to a dormant state and allows access to the doors.

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

Golem, Lesser, Clay: Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 7; HD 11; hp 49; THAC0 9; #AT 1; Dmg 3-30 (3d10); SA Can haste self for 3 rounds after one round of combat, damage from a clay golem can only be healed by a priest of 17th-level or greater; SD Hit only by magical blunt weapons, immune to fear, sleep, hold and charm spells; SZ L; ML Fearless (19-20); XP 8,000.

Casting a *Detect Magic* spell upon the symbol reveals that it is very magical and a *legend lore* spell reveals that it serves as a magical beacon for teleportation.

Protected by two 16th-level spells (*Wizard Lock*, and *Wyvern Watch*) the doors are otherwise identical to the first pair of doors.

Room #3, A Deadly Trap.

Upon opening the second set of double doors, you see a dark hallway 25' long. For the first 10' of the hall, its width is 15', but then it narrows to five feet wide. At the same spot that the hall narrows, the roof height also drops from 12' high to six feet. This room is noticeably cooler than the previous rooms (subterranean ambient temperature) and ends in a single blank stone door, similar to the previous double doors.

This door also bears two 16th-level spells: *Wizard Lock* and *Wyvern Watch*. The area at the point where the hall narrows and the roof height drops, is covered by a 16th-level *Alarm* spell. Searching for secret doors or traps reveals a small pressure plate under the door. Stepping upon the plate or moving it sets off a two-part mechanical and magical trap. The first part of the trap will slam shut and lock the doors at either end of the hall (or just lock them if they are already shut). Once the doors are shut and locked, they can not be unlocked from inside the room, although the room is not warded against magic and spells like *Dimension Door*, and *Teleport* allows escape from the hall. Upon completion of the first part of the trap, the second part of the trap lifts the cover to a modified *Eversmoking Bottle*¹⁸ vented into the hallway that emits sleep smoke instead of the usual variety of smoke. Smoke fills the room within one round and all characters within the room must save versus poison each round with a –2 penalty. Those characters failing their saving throw fall asleep for 1d4 days.

The drow, alerted by the *Alarm* spell, lie in wait for the sleep smoke to take effect (about a round) at which time Madame Nova will cast a *Wizard Eye* spell sending it into the room to ascertain what the trap has caught. Any character still awake causes Madame Nova to wait for the effect of the smoke before opening the trap. When all characters are asleep, she speaks the command word (“nepo” known only to Madame Nova) that shuts the stopper of the *Eversmoking Bottle*. After closing the bottle, she orders the trap opened and custody taken of the prisoners. Characters caught by Madame Nova wake up in the stockade stripped of all items but their clothing, including magical or very valuable clothing. The DM should skip ahead in this adventure to room #6. Evading this trap warrants an experience point bonus determined by the DM.

Room #4, A Maiden in Waiting.

This hallway is five feet wide and 30' long and has a six-foot high ceiling. This hall ends in a single stone door with an inset intricate iron lock. As you approach the southern end of the hall, the temperature begins to climb rapidly and quickly gets uncomfortable.

Searching for secret doors reveals a single secret stone door on the eastern wall about five feet from the entry. This door is locked both magically and mechanically. Searching for traps upon the secret door reveals the kissing maiden hidden in the roof triggered by attempting to pick the lock. Rendering the trap inoperable requires hammering some spikes into the surrounding stone preventing the kissing maiden from falling or finding and pulling the secret deactivation lever beside the door. Triggering the trap releases the kissing maiden that strikes any man-sized or larger creature in front of the door doing 4d8 points of damage and those struck must save versus poison because the spikes are coated with type E poison. Creatures smaller than man-sized and any creature under 5' 10" such as gnomes and halflings escape harm because they are below the reach of the trap. Finally after the disarming the trap, and picking the lock (with a –30% penalty to success due to its intricacies) the door still bears a 16th-level *Wizard Lock* spell.

The southern door is locked by the intricate iron lock and is also trapped with an identical kissing maiden as the secret door. Attempting to pick the lock or opening the door such as with a knock spell triggers the kissing maiden. This kissing maiden can be deactivated the same way as the previous one. After disarming the trap, picking the intricate iron lock suffers a –10% chance of success.

Room #5, Grisly Welcome.

Upon opening the secret door, you see a 15' wide, 35' long room lit with several floating glass globes of light. The roof is six-foot high and pierced with murder holes. A single iron-reinforced oak door on the northern wall leads from this room. The room reeks of decaying flesh and standing near the center of this room are 17 undead. Two of these undead are male humans dressed in fine robes with good chain mail underneath. Both wears sheathed short swords

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

hanging from a leather balderics. Studying them, you realize that they must have been identical twins in life. The pair bow to you and say in unison "Welcome to Madame's foyer, may we see your invitations please?"

These undead are Madame Nova's door guard and are animated by her consort, who is presently absent from the complex and not part of this adventure, but the DM could use him later for future adventures that tie in to this one. Talking to the two ju-ju zombie brothers politely causes one of them to politely leave, unlock the door and enter the following room. The rest of the zombies wait with the remaining brother until the zombie returns asking that they please remain here because Madame Nova would like to speak to them. Madame Nova will enter the room escorted by seven drow males and politely converses with the characters, offering what help she can, perhaps in exchange for something.

If attacked, or treated rudely, the twin brothers attack while screaming for help. Underneath this room accessed with a large secret trap door, is a large compartment within the floor that contains several undead. Within this compartment are two zombie lords, and two more ju-ju zombies, all twin brothers (the consort likes to collect twin brothers). The zombie lords carefully watch the characters entry and dealings with the first two ju-ju zombies and will command the remainder of the undead from this secret compartment to attack the characters along with the zombies in the room above. The two zombie lords will not enter combat unless forced too, but will get close enough so that their stench reaches the characters.

Zombie, Lord (2): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL NE; AC 6; MV 6; HD 6; hp 34, 31; THAC0 15; #AT 2; Dmg 2-8/2-8; SA odor (save vs poison); SD Spell immunity; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 650.

When forced into combat, it relies on the great strength of its two crushing fists. The odor of death surrounding the zombie lord is so potent it causes horrible effects in those who breathe it. On the first round a character comes within 30 yards, he must save vs. poison or be affected in some way. The following results are possible:

1d6 Roll	Effect
1	Weakness (as the spell).
2	Cause disease (as the spell).
3	-1 point of Constitution.
4	Contagion (as the spell).
5	Character unable to act for 1d4 rounds due to nausea and vomiting.
6	Character dies instantly and becomes a zombie under control of the zombie lord.

All zombies within sight of the zombie lord are subject to its mental instructions. Further, the creature can use the senses of any zombie within a mile of it to learn all that is happening within a very large area. Once per day, the zombie lord can animate dead to transform dead creatures into zombies. This works as described in the Player's Handbook except that it can be used on the living. Any living creature with fewer Hit Dice than the zombie lord can be attacked in this manner. A target that fails a saving throw vs. death is slain. In 1d4 rounds, the slain creature rises as a zombie under the zombie lord's command.

Zombie, Ju-ju (4): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL NE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 3+12; hp 22, 26, 24, 23; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg 3-12 or by weapon; SD immune to all mind effecting spells and illusions, immune to electricity, magic missiles, fire causes ½ damage, +1 or better weapon to hit, B & P weapons do 1/2 dmg, turned as spectres; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 975; each wears a decent set of chain mail, and wields a short sword.

Zombie, Common (35): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 8; MV 6; HD 2; hp 7x9, 15, 4, 7, 5x10, 8x12, 8x11, 2, 8; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8; SD Spell immunity; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 65.

The murder holes in the ceiling are for intimidation and are not real. Upon the western wall is the large winch for raising the kissing maiden.

Room #6, Madam Nova's Parlor.

The room where the adventurers awake in area #A behind a steel portcullis, if they were captured by the smoke bottle trap. In the center of this portcullis is a small door about three feet tall and four feet wide. Inset within the door is a very intricate padlock. The adventurers find themselves stripped of all gear and items except for clothing. Anything of a magical nature will be removed and studied by the renegade Drow, who may or may not return it to the owner. Standing on the other side of the portcullis facing the prisoners are a pair of Drow fighters with short recurve bows, each with an arrow knocked on the bowstring.

The DM must adjust the following room description to fit his campaign and the events that has happened so far in the adventure. This adventure is not written with the intent of the characters battling the Drow, so descriptions of the

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

complex are left to the DM to detail as befits his campaign. The DM should make it clear to the players that their characters are outmatched and that discretion is better than a suicide attack against these Drow.

This is a large, opulently furnished room with rich tapestries hanging on the walls. The room is 40' long and 25' wide with an arched roof that peaks at 12' high. Several chandeliers containing glowing glass globes hang from the roof on delicate fine metal chains dimly light the room. Several padded couches covered in dark leathers are scattered throughout the room, upon which several Drow of either sex and varied ages recline watching you intently. Upon three throne-like couches recline three female Drow each dressed in exquisite clothing and displaying a great amount of jewelry and weapons. The central female Drow is more elderly than the other two who sit in a posture suggesting subservience to the older female. Although older, her beauty has not diminished, but the steel of her will is evident in the respectful stance of everyone around her. The older female reaches into her loose robes and pulls a silver canister from which a silver goblet is extracted. Holding the goblet out, a young male rushes to fill it with a sparkling green wine. Although being unobtrusive, scattered throughout the room are 15 Drow warriors dressed in fine dark chain mail, over which a soft cloak is worn and high soft boots on the feet. Some of these warriors are quietly talking among themselves.

When the characters awake, one of the guards outside the portcullis calls quietly to Madame Nova will come to the bars by levitating and says in accented Common that she wishes to talk, and promises that right now the adventurers are not in any danger from her and the Drow. The other two female Drow follow, but upon foot, and remain behind Madame Nova in a respectful distance. Madame Nova does not threaten the adventurers, but seeks to unravel how they discovered her band of renegade Drow. She is very interested in their intentions and will listen intently when the adventurers speak. Madame Nova is a Drow of noble descent and the DM must play her as such. She had an excellent education and is from a mid-level prestigious family. She is middle age according to how Drow count their years. She will not be hostile to the adventurers even if there is a member that is of a traditional enemy race. Once that Madame Nova has determined that the adventurers are friendly, she will order them released and fed, but will not have their things returned to them until they leave (she is not a fool). If the adventurers are hostile to her, or threaten her, she will have them put back asleep with poison and then transport them to the surface. She will ensure that the adventurers are left far enough away that they could not get back to her enclave and within the hunting range of a fearsome creature like a manticores. If the adventurers are obnoxious to the point of pissing her off, she may have them tied to a tree or have their hands tied behind their back and let loose with bags of monster attractant hung around their necks.

Friendly and behaved adventurers will live longer and are invited to a dinner. She introduces her two companions as Darien and Theana, both half sisters to Madame Nova and help her maintain order. While eating, Madame Nova explains that she is the leader of this band of renegade Drow and that most of them worship Vhaeraun, the Drow god of thievery and furthering the interests of Drow upon the surface world. Although the worship of Vhaeraun is done primarily by males, Madame Nova and those females with her has been accepted by the deity. Following the tenets of her faith, Madame Nova desires peaceful trade with the surface world. She desires to arrange a trade mission with the adventurers but after they prove they can reach the surface again. When the adventurers return to the Underdark later, she will meet them to arrange trade and payment. The adventurers are allowed to remain for a few days to rest and heal, and if lacking any of the basic adventuring gear, the Drow may give it to them at the DM's discretion.

Precious information is gained from befriending the Drow. Madame Nova explains the dungeon past the enclave, and departs the information that there are two teleportation arches that provide access to other parts of the Forgotten Halls. Probably dwarven made, these arches are protected by riddles answered in the language that the riddle is written in. She does not impart the answers to the riddles because she desires to test the worthiness of the adventurers, and see if they can survive. Madame Nova explains that while there are several natural caverns and chasms in the complex, it is better to stick with the crafted halls, as the other sections are quite dangerous, and little explored. She also informs the adventurers about the access to the surface through the last teleportation mirror similar to the one that they employed to enter the halls, accessed through a descending natural passageway. The passage ends in a large natural cavern used as a pasture by wild rothe, but the Drow do not where on the surface it deposits the travelers. The Drow use another way of reaching the surface, one that they are not going to divulge to strangers. A rough map provided by Madame Nova details the complex to the first teleportation arch. She also gives the adventurers the password in the Drow language to safely pass the lightning golem, and deactivate the petrification trap at the bottom of the stairs from room #8. The Drow will not provide an escort or guide, as that would threaten their anonymity among the other Drow of the region. Depending upon whether or not the DM desires to use alternate rules for exposure, the Drow may furnish the characters with several decanters of fresh water, unless the characters have sufficient means of attaining water by magic.

While remaining within the enclave, the adventurers are free to talk to the other Drow. The other two co-leaders of the enclave, Darien and Theana, keep their motives to themselves but are guardedly friendly. All of the Drow are careful not to divulge their full names, houses, or anything else that could give their enclave away. Darien and Theana have experienced the surface before on raids, under the patronage of a mysterious Lord Jack. They have recently returned to the Underdark and joined the enclave ran by their half sister. Theana worships Mystra, and is a

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

lycanthrope (weretiger), while Darien worships Jiathuli¹⁹, and is the most introverted of the sisters and keeps mostly to herself. The male Drow fighters are led by Algorand who secretly plots to wrestle control of the enclave from Madame Nova, and feels resentment that his god has favored her, a mere woman. As most Drow societies are matriarchal, the followers of Vhaeraun are mostly males who desire to instill a patriarchic society which they see as the natural order. Algorand is patient and while he has not yet swayed enough of the males to his side, he is patient, and willing to wait before attempting a coup. Madame Nova was not truthful about the nature of some of the natural caverns within the area and Algorand may depart this information if he feels that it would benefit him. The reasons that Madame Nova lied about the natural caverns is to protect the Drow's territory and to prevent the adventurers from discovering other Drow strongholds in the area. The disinformation also protects the Drow from being discovered because the characters may run into other Drow from nearby cities.

Armed with the rough map and information the Drow release the adventurers back into the halls, but they blindfold them and wrap them in globes of darkness so that they cannot find the enclave's secret entrances. Detailing the rest of the enclave is up to the DM, but the characters are not intended to enter past room #6, where all business dealings will be carried out in the future.

Room #7.

Opening the last door on the southern wall reveals a wide room that is 15' square. The room has a ceiling that is 10' high and is very hot and dry. In the center of should have been the southern wall, there is empty space and a narrow 5'-wide stone bridge without a handrail. This bridge spans an immense cavern of indeterminable depth but is only 60' wide. Relentless waves of intense heat rise from the depths of the chasm and a miasma of sulphur washes over the bridge filling the room. Apparently made of solid stone, the bridge arches gently in the center. Faint dwarven runes engraved upon both sides of the bridge ask for the blessing of (Dwarven god).

The adventurers can safely cross the bridge quickly reaching the landing upon the other side, which is identical to the previous room. The heat over the center of the bridge is intense (around 145° Fahrenheit) and dawdling adventurers might suffer some damage. A character reading the dwarven runes along the bridge aloud and in the mountain dwarven tongue enacts a special *Bless* spell that protects everyone crossing the bridge, prevents damage from the heat, and gives a +1 bonus to all saving throws for 1d4 rounds. At the bottom of the chasm is a large pool of lava, and characters falling off the bridge are lost forever.

Room #8, Opposite Landing.

This landing is identical to the one that you just left except reversed. Upon the southern door is another single stone door shut tightly. Painted in black ink directly in the center of the door is the Drow word "sreen."

The door bears a 16th-level *Wizard Lock* spell. Sreen is a common Drow word to indicate danger. The door is trapped with a poisonous gas globe trap. Opening the door without disarming the trap releases four glass globes from the roof that shatter upon the stone floor releasing a poisonous gas cloud that effects everything within 15' of the door. Characters caught within the poisonous gas cloud must roll a successful save versus poison or suffer 4d6 points of damage.

Room #9, Danger Apparent.

Opening the door reveals a 10' long and 15' long wide room with a ceiling 12' tall. This room has a descending flight of stone stairs on the southern wall. Standing in front of this door is a large eight-foot tall, golden humanoid that glows with a crackling light like Saint Elmo's fire. Occasionally you see bright bolts of electricity arc from the trunk of the figure strike its upraised arms.

This creature is the lightning golem that Madame Nova warned the adventurers about and it has been here a long time. How the Drow figured out the password is unknown, and it is quite possible that the dwarves constructed the golem and placed it here as a guardian. Speaking the password (which is the command word for the golem as well) allows the characters to pass the golem safely accessing the stairs. Since the golem contains a large amount of gold, the characters might get greedy and attack the golem anyway despite the Drow's warning. Although the characters might have said the command word, attacking the golem causes it to retaliate. Repeating the command word after attacking the golem has no effect, and the golem will continue to attack the characters until they either are killed or flee the room across the bridge. The golem will not chase the characters across the bridge or down the stairs, and characters that rush past the golem and although suffering the attacks of the golem, reach the safety of the stairs, are safe and may continue to the bottom of the stairs.

Lightning golem: Intelligence 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 0; MV 12; HD 11; hp 55; THAC0 9; #AT 1; Dmg 4d8; SA See Below; SD See Below; SZ L; ML Fearless (19-20); XP 2,004.

The lightning golem moves much more quickly than one might expect an automaton to move. Because of this, it gains a +2 bonus to all initiative rolls that it is called upon to make.

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

When in close combat, the lightning golem lashes out with its metallic arms, trying to strike its enemies. Anyone hit by the being suffers 4d8 points of damage from the blow and its associated electrical shock. Anyone making a successful saving throw vs. spells or with some immunity to electrical damage suffers only half damage. Persons who fail their saves may be required (at the DM's option) to make saving throws for some or all of the items they are carrying.

If possible, the golem begins combat by unleashing a powerful stroke of chain lightning at its enemies. This attack is similar to that of the sixth-level wizard spell of the same name and has a range of 50 yards. The stroke inflicts 6d6 points of damage to the first target that it strikes.

Because of the inorganic nature of this being, the lightning golem is immune to all manner of life affecting magic or psionic powers. Thus, attempts to put it to sleep or cause disease fail. Spells and powers that influence the mind are similarly useless against this automaton. Attacks that depend upon heat or fire affect the golem normally, causing its golden skeleton to melt and deform. Those based on cold, ice, lightning, or electricity are ineffective. Spells and abilities that have power over metal, such as crystalbrittle, have their normal effects upon the lightning golem.

Lightning golems are considered greater golems, and are thus always under the control of their creator.

The golem is made of about 2,000 pounds of gold and if the characters destroy it, the DM should be strict with encumbrance for greedy characters. I would not allow the characters to attain that much wealth but each DM is free to run this adventure as he sees fit.

When the characters commence their descent of the stairs read the following:

The stairs descend 190' at a gentle 15° angle and as you descend farther into the earth the temperature drops noticeably and at the bottom, the temperature is the underground ambient temperature. The stairs end in a simple plain stone door with an iron bas-relief face of a large bull with great sweeping horns. Swinging from the bull's mouth through its teeth is a great large iron ring like some sort of subterranean doorknocker. As you approach (within 10'), the "doorknocker" bull's eyes begin to glow with a dark red light.

Casting *Detect Magic* upon the doorknocker reveals that it is quite magical and a simple (+15% chance of success) successful find traps roll discovers that the bull is also trapped. A simple and successful disarm traps roll (+15% chance of success) removes a single dart trap. The characters have the password to safely pass this trap, which is quite dangerous. Speaking the pass-phrase "jal khaless zhah waela" (all truth is foolish) in Drow deactivates the gas trap, and unless the characters miss the simple dart trap, the door opens swiftly upon speaking the pass-phrase. The eyes of the bull glow with the dark light until the trap is deactivated. The trap is only deactivated for 12 hours each time the phrase is spoken.

Touching any part of the door or the doorknocker without speaking the pass-phrase causes a billowing gas cloud to pour from the bull's mouth. This gas cloud has the same effect as the breath of a gorgon and affects everyone within 20' of the door. Characters caught within the gas cloud must save versus petrification or be turned into stone. The trap will release its gas cloud three times per day and then go dormant for 24 hours, during which time it replenishes its gas supply. During the time that the trap is dormant, the door is effectively locked and unable to be opened. It is possible to use magic to pass the door, or force the door open requiring 97 hp of damage.

Room #10.

This large, dark musty smelling room is 45' wide and 35' long. Apparently, this room must have once been a meeting hall or dining room some time in the past. In the center of the room is a broken great stone table in numerous pieces. Several rotting chairs scattered about this room and the debris upon the floor indicates that this room sees little use. The only exit from this room is an odd, rusty iron-reinforced wooden (oak) door. On this side of the door, the entire front of the door bears rusty but still effective spikes and the facing wall towards where the door opens is pitted with indentations from these spikes. The hinges to this door are on the left hand side and are unusually thick with large hasps and thick barrels.

Searching the room reveals a pair of useless rusty daggers, 2 gp, and a tarnished silver necklace worth about 5 gp. The spiked door is locked but with such a simple lock that a +45% chance of success applies. A *Detect Magic* spell reveals that the door is magical. However, as soon as the door is unlocked it slams open on the spring-loaded hinges, pinning man-sized and smaller creatures to the wall unless a successful Dexterity check is rolled. The door resets itself the next melee round after pinning something to the wall. Damage done to creatures struck by the door is 4d6 points. A detect traps roll identifies the trap but there is no way to disarm it other than destroying the door requiring 76 hp of damage be done to the door. Magic may be used to bypass the door, but the nature of its enchantment prevents spells like *Knock* from working upon the door, but spells like *Dispel Magic* deactivates the door for one melee round per level of the caster. While the door is deactivated, it may be picked and then pulled open by grasping the spikes. Characters that attempt to unlock the door from the side and let the door slam open must roll both a successful pick locks and Dexterity check to avoid damage from the door. Characters upon the side of the door attempting to pick it that failed

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their Dexterity check only suffer one-fourth damage from the door. Opening the door reveals another flight of stairs descending at a gentle 17° angle.

Room #11, The snail's trail.

When the character reach midpoint upon the stairs read the following:

There appears to have been a small earthquake recently as there is cracks within the stone and two gaping holes in the walls. The holes reveal a natural chasm running north and south. Every surface of this cavern glistens with a faint iridescence. The southern portion of this cavern extends past the limits of your sight and is lost in the gloom of the underworld. A strong odor of sulphur emits from the chasm.

If the characters ignore the Drow's well-meaning misdirection and explore the chasm, they discover a strange kind of lichen that emits a strange amount of faint light. Collecting some of this lichen the characters can fashion torches and lamps that require no heat and last 1d6 turns since harvesting. Storing lichen in containers like *Portable Holes*, *Bags of Holding* etc. results in the lichen lasting longer.

While searching the lichen-covered chasm, the characters discover a small brackish water stream running through the center of the chasm. Unfortunately the water contained within the stream is unfit to drink, it is heavily polluted with heavy salts, minerals, and sulphur. Characters can collect the water and purify it utilizing magic, but not enough water produced in this manner will support up to six characters under heavy exertion. Contently munching on lichen along this is a huge snail with twin round balls on its tail. Unless the characters molest the snail, it continues to feed peacefully. Attacking the snail causes it to relentlessly retaliate.

Flail snail 6 HD: Intelligence 5-7 Low intelligence; AL N; AC 4 (flail), -8 (body); MV 3; HD 6; hp 36; THAC0 15; #AT 5 (1 per tentacle); Dmg 1d8; SA Nil; SD See below; SZ L; ML Elite (13-14); XP 1,000.

A hit by a single tentacle causes 1d8 points of damage and can smash a one-inch-thick piece of wood. A four-tentacled snail makes four attacks as a 4 Hit Die creature, a three-tentacled snail makes three attacks as a 3 Hit Die creature, and so on. These attacks may be against one or two opponents. Both opponents must be in front of or to the side of the snail.

Flail snail tentacles have 1 Hit Die apiece. Treat each tentacle as a separate creature. When a tentacle is reduced to 0 hit points it is useless. Flail snails attack until all of their tentacles are dead. Once this happens the monster withdraws into its shell and dies 1d3 turns later. During these turns the snail utters pitiful cries that are 50% likely per turn to attract a wandering monster.

The body has hit points equal to the combined total of all the tentacles, but it is nearly impossible to attack because it is protected by the creature's shell. The effective Armor Class of the body is -8.

Flail snails are protected against magic by their colorful shell. Whenever the snail is attacked by magic, the effects are variable-40% chance of the spell malfunctioning, 30% chance of it functioning normally, 20% chance of it failing to work at all, and a 10% chance that the spell is reflected back at the spellcaster. A spell that malfunctions has its effect altered slightly (DM discretion). The altered spell then affects the creature nearest the snail (saving throw if applicable).

Flail snails are immune to fire and poison, but they shun bright light.

Searching the chasm takes a full day; during which time other denizens of the deep, including other Drow attracted by the ruckus of a battle, attack. There are other passages leading from this cavern and the characters could take any of these exploring the Underdark more. Revealed by searching the chasm are 36 gp, 4 sp, and a single rusty iron sword. All the items retrieved come from a Drow corpse that probably did not heed the warning about staying on the path.

Returning to the stairs and continuing down reveals that they end in a plain, untrapped, and unlocked stone door that opens easily.

Room #12.

Opening the door into this room reveals a large, dark room 30' wide and 15' long with a cathedraled roof that arches to a point 15' high. Dust-encrusted spider webs fill the room. Hacked through the webs is a trail leading to the only apparent exit. Near the center of the room, a dried hacked corpse of a huge spider lies on the floor.

Searching the room reveals nothing of interest but some useless rusty armor and weapons. Several desiccated cadavers of various underground species still cocooned in dusty spider webs. Searching these cocoons reveals nothing since they were ransacked long ago. The spider is quite dead and probably slain by dwarves or other subterranean explorers since Drow revere spiders so much. The door from this room is unlocked, untrapped and opens easily revealing a flight of stone steps rising at a steep 55° angle. As the characters reach midpoint upon the stairs, the air gets noticeably warmer and then returns to ambient underground temperature at the top. At the top of the stairs is another simple stone door identical to the previous one.

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

Room #13, The Landing.

Opening the door reveals a room apparently designed as a landing for several flights of stairs to culminate. Several other flights of stairs lead off into the gloom in several directions. Some of these flights of stairs collapsed, some appear usable but could be dangerous, and others appear sturdy and well used. Upon the north and south walls are a flight of stairs that are each choked with rubble. A clear flight of stairs upon the eastern wall descends at a sharp 55° angle. Within this stairwell is a Drow character painted in dark red paint.

The symbol indicates that this stairwell is safe. The stairwell on the southern wall is artfully choked off, and clearing the rubble takes four rounds (during which time the DM should roll random encounters at least once). At the DM's discretion, some of the other stairs although cracked and fallen into disrepair may lead to expanding this dungeon complex.

Room #14, the first arch.

When the characters enter the room at the bottom of the stairs, read the following paragraph. If the characters did not encounter the Drow, modify the following paragraph omitting reference to the characters knowing that there is a riddle within this room.

At the bottom of the stairs is a room that is 15' square with an arched roof 15' high at the peak. The dimly lit room has a shimmering arch of fine stone that comprises the eastern wall. This stone arch is 12' high at the peak and spans eight feet. Between the spans of the arch is a shimmering veil of light that ripples like water. Along the other three walls of the room, are tidy carved stone shelves rising from floor to ceiling. Filling every shelf are various skulls of every type and size. The arrangement of the skulls is from smallest at the top to the largest at the bottom. Some of the skulls are from races easy to identify, while others are giant, specimens from species you surely hope no longer reside in these halls. Two odd things strike you as you stand within this room. The first is that there is a small brass plaque nailed to the forehead of each skull. The plaques are smooth, plain and although polished to a high luster. The other is that there is supposed to be a riddle around here somewhere but you fail to see one.

Searching the room fails to reveal any riddle, but discovers a small, untrapped lever on the western wall. Pulling this lever causes a section of the floor to open. Read the following paragraph.

After pulling the lever, a small section of the floor in the center of the room opens and a beautiful stone statue rises from the depths of the floor. This statue is of a beautiful woman dressed in long, loose robes with her arms raised as if to embrace a lover. On her head is a rusty iron headdress in the shape of a scorpion. Clinched within the claws of the scorpion is a large diamond (value determined by the DM). At the base of the statue is a short paragraph.

The paragraph is written in an ancient language requiring ancient language proficiency or a *Read Languages* spell to read. Once translated, the paragraph reads, "Mighty Selket²⁰, protector of the dead." Searching the statue for secret or hidden things reveals that the scorpion's tail upon the head of the statue is a lever, and that the diamond is securely mounted. In order to free the diamond, the iron scorpion will have to be damaged possibly ruining it. Casting a *Detect Magic* spell reveals that the statue, scorpion, and diamond are very magical. The skulls are not magical and may be removed from the shelves.

Pulling down upon the tail of the scorpion causes the diamond to light up equivalent of bright sunlight. The beams of light stream from the gem in a silent barrage of light, striking the brass plaques upon the skulls. This light display causes several lines of verse to float in the air at chest height. Written in the same language as the words upon the base of the statue, these lines of verse and require another *Read Languages* spell or ancient languages proficiency check to read. Once translated the lines of verse are a riddle:

"What creature walks on four legs in his morning?
Two legs in his afternoon
And three legs in his evening?"

The answer is man, human, or mankind spoken in the same language as the riddle. Speaking the correct answer activates the teleportation arch, and characters stepping into the arch are immediately teleported to room #15.

Characters that destroy more than three skulls (each has seven hp), destroy the statue or scorpion, or displace more than seven skulls render the statue inoperable and it will not display the riddle. Removing the diamond or destroying the iron scorpion also renders the statue inoperable. Removing more than four plaques from the skulls also renders the statue inoperable. Depending upon the skill level of the players, the DM might want to hint that greedy players not take the diamond, or the characters will not be able to operate the teleportation arch. An alternative is letting the players destroy skulls, remove the diamond (value determined by the DM), and any other notion but teaching them that such actions have consequences by deactivating the arch. These characters are going to have to back track and utilize some other portions of the dungeon to work around the inoperable teleportation arch. Using this option, the DM must be ready to expand the dungeon and decide if the characters are going to be able to attain the goals of this

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By Steven K Allen

Scorge30@hotmail.com

adventure after rendering the first teleportation arch inoperable. One more alternative is applying a two percent penalty for each skull or plaque that the characters deface. When the characters activate the statue displaying the riddle, apply the cumulative penalties to the chance that the riddle will be scrambled, missing words, or very faint.

The Forgotten Halls, Level 3

Room #15, a warm welcome.

When the characters arrive in the new room, read the following paragraph. If the characters did not enter this room by going through the teleportation arch, modify the description of this room.

You arrive in a small room identical to the previous, except that, this room lacks a teleportation arch, and the macabre decoration. This room is incredibly hot, rendering infravision useless. A single flight of stairs descends from the eastern wall at a gentle 15° angle.

The temperature in the room is 165° Fahrenheit. Exiting the room by descending the stairs reveals that the temperature drops to near underground ambient temperature at the bottom of the stairs. Searching the very hot room reveals nothing of interest.

Room #16, the first sleeping room.

Entering this simple stone landing reveals that the room might have been designed as a rest area. The room is 15' wide and 10' deep with a ceiling nine feet high. Along the northern wall are several rows of stone benches that appear designed for sleeping. At the end of each bench is a small fireplace displaying heavy use that warmed the sleeping benches, where the smoke exhausts to is unknown. Upon the southern wall is a small water fountain containing brackish yellow water that a strong smell of sulphur emanates from. Descending from the eastern wall is another flight of stone stairs descending at a gentle 15° angle. At either end of the room, the remains of twin wooden doors are evident, but the doors and the assumed crosspieces are missing.

Where and when the doors disappeared is unknown, but obviously was done with great force. Perhaps they were smashed into bits and burnt in the fireplaces under the sleeping benches to warm other travelers. Obtaining water purified by magic from the fountain is possible, but not enough obtained in this manner to support up to six characters under heavy exertion. However, water obtained here and at the previous location in the chasm will retard damage, and may reduce penalties suffered at the DM's discretion.

Room #17, the second sleeping room.

When the characters enter this room read the following paragraph.

At one time, this room was identical to the previous room, but it has suffered severe damage in the past. The ceiling has partially collapsed creating a mound of rubble in the center of the room, revealing a large natural cavern above this room. A small puddle of yellow brackish water lies in the center of this room around the rubble pile, fed by a small stream that trickles from the natural cavern along the southern wall. This room has a sharp repugnant odor, as if rotting old meat mixed with the strong smell of sulphur. Descending from the eastern wall is another flight of stone stairs. The doors are also missing from this room, and the sleeping benches are probably buried under the rubble in the center of the room.

The cavern over this room is home to a female drider cleric. She will wait for the characters to give her a chance to attack from the rear by dropping a *Globe of Darkness* upon the largest concentration of characters. She attacks from cover, with surprise and a higher position giving her a +4 bonus to her initial attack and +2 to subsequent attacks. The drider is more than 50% concealed forcing the characters to suffer a -4 penalty to their attacks. Other than exiting the room, the characters are unable to gain any shelter within the room.

Drider cleric: INT 17; AL CE; AC -2; MV 12; HD 6+6; hp 45; THAC0 13; #AT 1; Dmg 1-4 or by weapon; SA poisonous bite does 1d4, save versus poison at -2 or be paralyzed for 1-2 turns; SZ L; ML 14; XP 5,000; Monstrous Compendium; *Drow Composite Short Bow* +2; *Footman's Mace* +2; *Drow chain mail* +3; 23 arrows poisoned with Drow sleep poison, (renders victim unconscious unless a successful saving throw versus poison is made with a -4 penalty which lasts 2d4 hours) four arrows poisoned by same poison as bite; two *Potions of Healing*; Spells: *Combine*; *Cure Light Wounds* (x2); *Detect Good*; *Purify Food and Drink*; *Augury*; *Slow Poison*; *Spiritual Hammer*; *Locate Object*.

Stashed within the cavern is 124 gp, and 1,324 gp in various small semiprecious and precious stones and small pieces of art. Concealed under a small pile of rocks are a pair of *Potions of Extra Healing*, the cleric's prayer book, and three vials of Drow poison. Madame Nova knew about this drider and purposely did not tell the adventurers about her hoping that either the characters would kill the drider, or the drider would kill the adventurers proving they were unfit to trade with. Madame Nova traded with the drider in a mutually beneficial relationship that was not friendly, but lately the drider began attacking members of Madame Nova's enclave and refusing to abide by a previous agreement. It is

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

unlikely that the characters would ever learn these facts, unless imparted by the DM, but there is possibly more intrigue here that could be expanded to fit the DM's campaign.

Room #18.

After the characters, descend the stairs, read the following to the players.

This large room has had the door smashed in some time in the past and its crushed ruin lies upon the floor just within the entrance. The room is 20' wide and 15' long with a flat even roof 12' that has suffered damage and a limited collapse with a large pile of rubble under the damaged area. Scattered within the room are several small items. Three partially-used torches, three partially-used black tallow candles, a broken iron bone-handled knife, a fancy embroidered scabbard for a dagger, a rotting stuffed black cat, and a dented pewter mug.

Searching the room and the articles reveals nothing of interest or value. The stuffed animal is similar to what a child would play with, and despite the rot and mold, is in decent shape. The scabbard could still be used, but the leather is starting to rot and would not last long. Completely digging through the rubble takes approximately six rounds (during which the DM should roll for random encounters twice) and reveals a crushed orcish skeleton underneath the rubble.

Exiting the room upon the ? side is a down-ward sloping smooth passage that descends at a steep 25° angle. At the bottom of this passage is a cross roads where the carved passage bisects a natural cavern (room #18).

Room #18, the natural cavern.

Looking into the depths of this room reveals that it is immense, and some areas of the cavern are beyond the range of your sight. To the east you can hear the faint sounds of trickling water. Surrounding the area where the sound of water comes from is a large fungi forest containing several different species of mushrooms. Some of these mushrooms tower over eight feet high, while others are quite small. The air within the room smells strongly of rotting eggs (sulphur).

Characters entering the room, notice that the air is damp and cool. Entering the fungi forest, there are several edible species and a character with a botany or underground specialty that the DM determines could be of help could gather enough edible mushrooms to support the characters. Searching the fungi forest reveals nothing of interest other than the edible mushrooms. However, there are several species of poisonous mushrooms, and characters that blindly pick mushrooms are in danger of eating a deadly mushroom.

Exploring the sounds of water reveals a sluggish, yellow-stained murky sliver of water that winds through the room. The polluted water contains high amounts of heavy salts, sulphur, iodine, and selenium. Water purified by magic from this river could support the characters if the DM desires, but the adventure is written so that there is not quite enough to support the characters, but enough to barely maintain life and prevent damage. As the characters explore the muddy edges of the water, four scraggs hiding within the mushrooms leap to the attack.

Scraggs (4): INT 6; AL CE; AC 3; MV 3; Sw 15; HD 5+5; hp 44, 40, 36, 33; THAC0 15; #AT 3; Dmg 2-5/2-5/3-12; SD regenerate only when immersed in fresh water; MR Nil; SZ L; ML 14; XP 650; Monstrous Compendium.

The scraggs are not going to be able to regenerate since there is no water, and will flee if damaged enough to threaten their life. Searching the area around where the scraggs attack reveals numerous semiprecious stones that when all are collected yields 29 gp in various, small-uncut stones. Searching this portion of the room for secret or hidden items reveals a leather and wooden pack frame hidden under some dead mushrooms. Searching the pack frame reveals three tin flasks of barely wine sealed with red wax, a *Potion of Extra Healing* in a glass container clearly marked, three rusty iron spikes, an ornate silver whistle (worth 4 gp), four glass vials of lamp oil, a useable but dented bulls eye lantern, and a tin box containing tinder and flint. For further expansion, the DM can expand the natural cavern to the west later.

Room #20.

This room is 25' long and 15' wide and appears to be a natural cavern that was squared out. The walls are for the most part made of natural stone while the floor and 12' high ceiling are worked stone but were left rough with tool marks evident on both. Upon the northern wall is a large, curved stone arch nine feet tall and spanning six feet at the base. The area between the arch and wall contains a shimmering curtain of light. Just in front of the center of the arch, etched deeply into the floor are a series of words spelling and ancient riddle.

Written in an ancient version of the common tongue that the characters can read with a successful Intelligence check, the short riddle reads:

“What has a face, but no eyes
Hands, but no fingers?”

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

The correct answer is a clock, timepiece or watch spoken in the same language as the riddle is written. Speaking the correct answer activates the teleportation arch teleporting the characters to room #20.

The Forgotten Halls, Level #4

Room #21, the charnel house.

Upon arriving within this room, the first two things that you notice is the awful stench of death, and that you have arrived in this room standing upon the remains of the losers of a large battle. The large dark cool room is 30' long by 25' wide and has a smooth flat roof nine feet high. The southern wall has a single opening within it revealing a hallway leading from this room. At one time, there was a door covering this exit on the southern wall, but it disappeared a long time ago. Standing among these dead, some are starting to move.

Within this collection of dead are 6 sword wraiths, 33 skeletons, and 25 zombies. The sword wraiths are the remains of a professional band of mercenaries that died here millennia ago in a forgotten battle. The wraiths attack all who enter this room, and occasionally prey upon the rothe in room #24, and other travelers in these halls.

Wraith, Swordwraith (6): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 3; MV 9; HD 7+3; hp 44, 28, 30, 49, 35, 36; THAC0 13; #AT 3/2 (as 7th level fighter); Dmg 1d10; SA Strength drain; SD +2 or better weapon to hit; SZ M; ML Fearless (19-20); XP 650.

Skeleton (26): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 12; HD 1; hp 3x5, 4x4, 5x7, 3x2, 3x6, 4x1, 3x8, 3; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-6 (weapon); SD immune to sleep, charm, hold spells & cold, 1/2 dmg from P & S weapons; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 65.

Skeleton, Warrior (1): Int. 15-16 Exceptionally intelligent; AL NE; AC 2; MV 6; HD 9+2; hp 45; THAC0 11; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon type (+3 to attack rolls); SA Flee in panic (creatures with less than 5HD); SD Only hit by magical weapons; SZ M; ML Champion (15); XP 4,000.

Skeleton, Monster (6): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 6; MV 12; HD 6; hp 24, 36, 29, 21, 22, 25; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg Special; SA Use giant weapons (but no strength bonus); SD immune to sleep, charm, hold spells & cold, 1/2 dmg from P & S weapons; SZ L, H; ML Fearless (20); XP 650.

Zombie, Common (23): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 8; MV 6; HD 2; hp 6x6, 2x9, 13, 3x12, 11, 4, 4x7, 5, 16, 10, 14, 8; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8; SD Spell immunity; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 65.

Zombie, Cannibal Corpse "Hungry Dead" (3): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL NE; AC 8; MV 6; HD 2d10; hp 17, 7, 5; THAC0 18; #AT 1; Dmg 1d6; SD Special; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 350.

Like zombies, they are immune to sleep, charm, hold, and cold based spells. Except in their animation concentrated area, the hungry dead are immune to physical attack. The area of concentration is usually the head but at the DM's discretion, it could be any part of the body (heart, stomach, etc.).

At first, "to hit" rolls of a natural 19-20 are needed to affect them (simulating an attack to one particular area of the body). After the first attack accidentally succeeds, the PCs should realize the problem and try to aim for the vulnerable area; using called shots, etc.

Clerics have the same chance to turn hungry dead as they do ghouls.

Note: there is such an unnatural hunger that once a victim is slain, 1d4+1 hungry dead will stop attacking to feed on the slain victim. Hungry dead will not eat other undead, only fresh slain corpses.

Found within the room are 13 pp, 244 gp, 17 sp, 46 cp, and 245 gp in miscellaneous small gems. Searching the room for secret or hidden items reveals a secret compartment at the base of the western wall. The secret compartment is locked but not trapped. A matched pair of *Throwing Daggers* +3 is stashed within the secret compartment. Leaving the room, there is a noticeable rise in temperature, humidity and the sound of pouring water emanates from farther down the hall. The strong smell of sulphur emanates from the other end of the hall.

Room #22, the boiling subterranean waterfall.

The door to this room has disappeared a long time ago, although you can see where the door once sat. The room beyond the door is hidden by a cascading boiling waterfall that falls from a large crack in the roof just inside the doorway. The water pours from the room towards the left through another large crack in the floor although it forms a small wide pool in the area that is shallow. The area around the waterfall is very warm and humid. The area around the

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

waterfall is stained yellow and deposits of minerals and salts around the waterfall suggest that the water has been pouring from the holes for a while. The warm water and the mist surrounding the area limits vision, and the noise while not terribly loud is loud enough that hearing is difficult in the area. You are able to peek around the waterfall some and determine that the room beyond appears to be very wide and deep, but because of the blocking waterfall, you cannot be sure of the exact size. The room is dimly lit however by a faint white light that seems to emanate from the center of the room. The only thing that you can truly determine is that the roof is 25' high and made of smooth stone.

The water is terribly hot around 180° Fahrenheit and characters that brave the water by jumping through it are mildly scalded suffering 2d4 points of damage. Using shields or other items to block the fall of water reduces the damage to 1d4. Using magic to block the water removes the chance of damage. The mist around the area limits sight to about 10' and eliminates infravision, but once characters clear the waterfall's immediate area, infravision returns. The room is approximately 45' deep in this area but opens up to the north and south beyond the character's vision. Parts of this cavern are natural, while others are obviously shaped by tools. A large portion of this cavern bears stalactites and malactites some of which are quite large.

Relaxing on the other side of this room against a wall is a large band of Drow with slaves and "allies." With the Drow are nine trained hook horrors carrying heavy loads. In battle these hook horrors have to drop their load taking one round before they can enter the battle. They are returning from a scouting and looting mission. Because of the noise of the waterfall, they will not have heard the battle between the dead soldiers and the adventurers, but once the characters step through the waterfall; they will be plainly visible to these Drow with no cover to hide. The Drow, upon discovering the adventurers, will immediately cover themselves with *Globes of Darkness* and seek to hide within the cavern ordering the "allies" and hook horrors into battle. Not being fools, the Drow bide their time letting the slaves determine who among the characters are spell casters and clerics and then attack from the roof while *Levitating* behind *Globes of Darkness*. The Drow hiding among the stalactites on the roof are 25% concealed and the characters suffer a –2 penalty to their attack rolls against the Drow. Alternatively, if the DM desires, these are more renegade Drow although still faithful to Lloth, which might be willing to talk to the characters and may trade information with them for a price. These Drow are not friendly and while they have broken from their city and seek to establish a new city (to be the greatest place of worship to Lloth in the Realms), they will only talk with the characters if they have something worthwhile to trade. Information about the enclave of non-Lloth worshipping Drow would qualify as material information of worth or the DM can determine another source of information worthwhile to these Drow. Led by the female Drow cleric of Lloth, these Drow are seasoned fighters and experienced in warfare within the Under Dark. The cleric sees herself as a Drow version of Eve, desiring to be the mother of a whole city. The cleric may be a little insane, but what may seem as insane to others may be quite sane to Drow. It is also possible that the cleric is currently enjoying the favor of Lloth and may be under her influence.

Llothall'rosoth: Dark (drow) elf female C6 S 11, D 17, C 14, I 13, W 16, Ch 12; AL Chaotic Evil; AC 1; MV 12; hp 24; THAC0 18; XP 975.

Hobgoblin (20): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 5; MV 9; HD 1+1; hp 2x7, 3x6, 5x4, 4x9, 8, 2x3, 3x5; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35; wielding maces, spears, axes, and javelins.

Drow elf males F2 (11): S 11/0, D 7, C 6, I 8, W 17, Ch 10; AL CE; AC 4; MV 8; hp 9, 5, 18, 11, 7, 8, 6, 14, 4, 8, 2; THAC0 19; XP 35; wearing *Drow Chain Mail* +2, each carries a long dagger and short sword of adamantium alloy, but three bear hand crossbows with poisonous darts.

Muga Foe's Fiend: Hobgoblin male Sh5 S 15, D 14, C 14, I 14, W 17, Ch 9; AL Lawful Evil; AC 1; MV 4; hp 11; THAC0 18; XP 650.

Hobgoblin, Leader: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 3; MV 9; HD 1d1+8; hp 9; THAC0 17; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35; wearing *Chain Mail* +2, a medium shield and wielding a *Bastard Sword* +2.

Hobgoblin Sub-chief: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC -1; MV 9; HD 2; hp 11; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon +2 on damage; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 65; wielding a *Hand Axe of Quickness*, a medium shield and wearing *Banded Mail* +3.

Hook Horror (9): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 3; MV 9; HD 5; hp 23, 2x22, 13, 24, 30, 31, 16, 19; THAC0 15; #AT 3; Dmg 1-8/1-8/2-12; SZ L; ML Steady (11-12); XP 175.

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

Human, Slave (12): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL N; AC 10; MV 12; HD 1d6; hp 6, 3x2, 4x4, 1, 3x5; THAC0 20; #AT ; Dmg ; SZ M; ML Unreliable (2); XP 15.

The hook horrors are carefully raised and bred by these Drow, a specialty of their previous city, and use them for heavy shock troops. They are too stupid for anything else but fighting, and heavy lifting and are handled with great care since they have been known to turn on their handlers. The hobgoblins believe that they are the allies of the Drow, a misconception since the Drow view them as cannon fodder, and little better than the slaves are. If the characters battle the Drow and win, searching the cleric's *Bag of Holding* reveals several small packets of black cloth. Inside these packets is a fortune in uncut gem stones totaling 4,258 gp. Some of these gems are banded agate, obsidian, moonstone, black onyx, jade, jet, black opals, black sapphires, and several rich blue diamonds. These gems stolen from the Drow's previous city are mundane with the exception of the blue diamonds of a unique luster that other Drow from the same city or surrounding area would immediately recognize. The mine that produces these wondrous gems is found only within that city's realm of influence. Should the characters keep some of these diamonds and either use them as trade or display them in jewelry, they might have some uncomfortable encounters in the Under Dark when encountering other Drow. Also found within the bag is the cleric's prayer book, and two *Potions of Extra Healing*. Searching the hook horrors' loads reveals mundane underground traveling material enough to support a group of 15 Drow for a month. The exact materials are up to the DM, but may include fresh water, food, wine, spare clothing, and basic necessities.

Characters with enough magic and material can collect enough purified fresh water from the waterfall to support themselves. The characters will need enough material to collect the water letting it cool and then purify it using magic. The polluted water contains the same elements as the other water sources in this complex.

Room #23.

As the characters exit the previous room, they enter this long winding passageway and travel for nearly a mile before they enter this room. The worked passageway slowly descends deeper underground at a very slight angle and possibly, only a dwarven character would notice this.

[The passageway suddenly ends in a large natural cavern. The cavern is 15' wide and 25' long with a roof of varying heights but averages about 65' high.](#)

The characters travel about a mile after leaving this room before reaching the entrance to the next room.

Room #24.

[You come upon a huge, dark natural cavern. The cavern extends in every direction past the reach of any vision and light. The densely filled cavern contains several species of lichen, moss, and fungi, some of which are quite large. A large pool of shallow steaming yellow-stained water is not too far from the entrance \(near the center of the room\). This pool lies at the base of a large mound. Grouped around the mound eating the moss and fungi are many black and brown bison-like creatures. There are nine smaller creatures near them that are under the careful observation of the larger creatures and you assume these are young guarded by their parents. These creatures are alert and wary.](#)

Within the mound is the lair of a drider mage and his familiar a sinister bat that is flying within the cavern and has reported the presence of the adventurers unless they have taken steps to obscure their entrance. The drider is in possession of the teleportation mirror to the surface. He enjoys the power and status of owning this magical device and in his warped mind; this is a fitting position for him. With an appropriate bribe, the drider mage allows creatures to use this mirror and has made himself rich, powerful, feared and several enemies one of them Madame Nova, who has occasionally scryed this room to see if the characters managed to reach the mirror. Madame Nova hopes that the characters will slay the drider mage erasing a problem from her area without her risking any of her people.

The drider alerted to the approach of the characters by his familiar, will climb to the top of the mound and greet the characters first in under common and then surface common. He will attempt to assess their strengths and weaknesses by how they act and respond to his questions. The DM must be careful to portray the drider as cultured and well educated, with excellent manners while still being very dangerous. If asked he freely admits that he has the mirror and may even boast of it. Depending upon the DM and what the characters are willing to offer as a bribe for the use of the mirror, the drider allows the characters to use the mirror and leave the area disappointing Madame Nova but not enough to sour relations with the characters. Suitable bribes could be mage's spell books, gems of sufficient worth (particularly ones taken from other Drow) or all of the parties' gems. However, if a character possesses a *Wish* spell in either scroll or spell book, the drider will do anything to possess it and will gladly trade the use of the mirror for the spell. Depending upon how the characters interact with the drider, such as alluding that they have a *Wish* spell but offering something else instead or are unwilling to trade the spell, the drider may attack the characters anyway or just the one that possess the spell. Remember that the drider is unpredictable because of his chaotic and evil nature. A favorite tactic since the characters enter the mirror one at a time, is to let part of the party go and attack the remainder preferably once the fighters and clerics have left. He will not chase any characters into the mirror, and once through the mirror the characters are safe from the drider and out of the complex.

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Scorge30@hotmail.com

Elf, Drider Mage: Int. High to Supra-Genius (14-20); AL CE; AC 3; MV 12; HD 6+6; hp 28; THAC0 13; #AT 1; Dmg 1-4 (+ poison) or by weapon; SA Spells as 6th - 8th level mage; SZ L; ML Elite (14); XP 3,000; *Mace of Wreckage*²¹; *Sikken*²² (+2 dagger); *Necklace of Mystic Eidolons*.

Bat, Sinister (very intelligent): Int. 11-12 Very intelligent; AL LE; AC 3; MV 3, Fl 18(C); HD 4+4; hp 24; THAC0 17; #AT 1; Dmg 2-5; SA Magic use (hold monster once a day); SD Energy field (stops missile attacks); SZ L; ML Champion (15-16); XP 2,000; *Ring of Protection* +2.

The rothe are not aggressive and will quickly evade the characters. However, if they attack the rothe form ranks around the young to protect them. The nine young are AC 6, have one HD and five hp.

Rothe (19):

Room #25, The drider's lair.

Entering the drider's lair through a gentle, downward-sloping tunnel with a 16'-high roof, you notice that it is brightly lit and warm. The tunnel is also trapped twice which the drider will disarm if the characters are entering the tunnel with him. Both traps contain six thin glass globes, which drop from the ceiling if the pressure plate is stepped upon with more than 25 pounds of force. Three of these glass globes are filled with ascomoid spores and the other three are flash globes. Locating both traps is not difficult but the cunning construction of the pressure plates causes the thief attempting to disarm the traps to suffer a -25% chance of success. Both traps drop their globes and effect an area 10' in diameter, and all creatures within the area of effect must save versus poison or die within 1d4 rounds from infection. Those who successfully save are blinded and choked to such an extent that they require 1d4 rounds to recover. Those who fail are also blinded and out of action (scratching furiously) for 6+1d4 rounds or until their eyes are flushed with fresh water for a full round. The luminous droplets cause an AC penalty of +2 even if the characters save versus poison. Those characters that fail are completely helpless; all attacks against them are at +4 bonus, with no shield or Dexterity bonuses allowed.

Entering the small chamber under the mound reveals it to have the pungent unique smell of a drider, and has been lived in for some time. The room is 45' deep and 25' wide and has a ceiling 18' high. Upon twin ledges on either side of the room stacked boxes, chests, and bags made of various materials. In the center of the eastern wall is a large, gilt-framed mirror covered in a thick black felt curtain.

Searching the room reveals 12 pp, 148 gp, 137 sp, 267 ep, 3,402 gp in various gems (both cut and uncut, but all unmounted), the drider's spell books and several scrolls. The spell books contains the spells that the drider has memorized plus the spells *Spidereyes*, *Spider Climb*, *Hold Portal*, and *Dark Wings*. Within the chests are old Drow clothes, possibly the drider's before he was changed. None of the clothing is of real value to the adventurers, but some of the cloth might fetch a fair price determined by the DM in the right market. Stashed within the clothes are a few scrolls of mundane house records that might be of interest to the right sage (the DM can include any adventure hooks and red herrings he desires here). Tucked within the records is a rare Drow spell *Protection from Earth and Stone*. Found within the mounds of bags is mundane adventuring gear, such as hooded lanterns, lamp oil, rotting lengths of hemp rope, and other such items of little or no use. However, if the characters carefully search the pile, for at least four rounds they uncover a pair of *Bracers of Defense* AC 2, a *Ring of Feather Falling* and a *Ring of Armoring*.

The mirror requires no words to activate it, is set to the same area, and cannot be shifted. The characters only need to step into the mirror, which will transport an unlimited number of items per day as long as they are ogre-sized or smaller. The mirror is not permanently mounted and can be removed, however, there is no way to utilize the mirror's power and take it with you.

Summary.

The DM is encouraged to remember that Drow items disintegrate in normal sunlight and when the adventurers return to the surface, most of the magical items retrieved from fallen Drow are going to be rendered useless in a short time. Any item exposed to the light of the sun for more than two rounds in at a time any exposure totaling more than five rounds in any five-day period irreversible decay begins. Within 2d6 days, the items lose their magical properties and crumble to worthless dust. Items protected from direct sunlight still lose their magical properties within 1d20+30 days. The DM should make note of what Drow items the adventures carry, especially the Drow cleric's *Bag of Holding* since when the bag is destroyed, all items within are lost.

The renegade Drow can become an unusual source of information and commerce in the Underdark region and can become a central focal point for the DM to use as adventure hooks for later forays into the Underdark. The complex may be linked with other such adventures as the U series, and any other adventure set within the Underdark.

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¹ Alternate spelling Goibhniu, and known in Wales as Gofannon, both derived from the word for smith. Part of the triad of craftsman-gods, the others being Luchta (or Luchtain) the wright and Creidhne the worker in metal; Celtic Mythology page 34 by Proinsias Mac Cana, new revised edition ©1985.

² Deities and Demigods page #28. In my campaign, this deity is a minor power with a very small amount of worshippers mostly found in the North among barbarians and sea folk.

³ Named after Bartlesville, OK in honor of my grandfather who lived there for a while.

⁴ Drow of the Underdark pages 42-44.

⁵ Symbols of the Celts by Sabine Heinz ©1999. Celtic legend refers to ducks that retrieve magical items from bodies of water.

⁶ Symbols of the Celts by Sabine Heinz ©1999.

⁷ Dictionary of Celtic Myth and Legend page 106 by Miranda J. Green ©1992 and The Encyclopedia of Religion Volume #3 page 155 by Mircea Eliade.

⁸ This is a symbol of his office, as well as a magical item, and oaths and promises made while holding a torque are considered binding and no member of this church or the two brethren churches would dare break a promise made upon a torque lest bad luck befall him; Symbols of the Celts page 179 by Sabine Heinz ©1999.

⁹ In my campaign, several orc tribes are advanced enough to maintain horses, and there are large tribes of scro taken from the Spelljammer setting.

¹⁰ I, Tyrant page 11 and 75.

¹¹ Dragon Magazine #147 “Magic for Beginners” by Gregory W. Detwiler.

¹² Unearthed Arcana page 52.

¹³ Dungeon Master’s Guide Table #51 page 73.

¹⁴ Dragon Magazine #179 “Unique Magical Candles for Your Campaign” by Gregg Chamberlain.

¹⁵ Gods, Goddesses, and Monsters page 76-77 ©2000 by Sheila Keenan. Janus was the Roman god of beginning and all gates, and doors where under his protection. The origins of Janus may be from the Gauls, contemporaries of the Celts and the Romans might have adopted his worship from conquering these people. His gate on the Northeast side of the Roman Forum was closed in peace and opened in wartime. Another minor deity in my campaign, who fulfills the same role as he did for the Romans, and is allied with Mystra, and Azuth, because magical gates fall within his portfolio.

¹⁶ Unearthed Arcana page 37.

¹⁷ The Drow of the Underdark page 99.

¹⁸ Dungeon Master’s Guide page 168.

¹⁹ Drow of the Underdark, page, god of

²⁰ Deity from

²¹ Lore of the Crypt, Book #1 Magical Treasures, Underworld Publishing page ?

²² Lore of the Crypt, Book #1 Magical Treasures, Underworld Publishing page ?